FOSTER ♥ GREATNESS

PROGRAM IMPACT REPORT

Thriver *Pathways* build careers & restores belonging for former foster youth.

A cohort-based career readiness program designed by and for foster alumni - where professional growth happens inside a community that already knows your name.

PROGRAM PERIOD	APPLIED TO PARTICIPATE	ENROLLED	COMPLETED ALL REQUIREMENTS
FEBRUARY - MARCH 2026	84 former foster youth	48 foster alumni	15 participants

ABOUT THE PROGRAM

What is Thriver Pathways?

Thriver Pathways is a virtual career readiness cohort program for former foster youth created by Foster Greatness and Str8Up Employment Services. The program combines workforce development with the one thing most career programs miss: a community of people who actually understand the road you've traveled.

REPORT PUBLISHED Spring 2026

text.

> *The most valuable thing I gained from Thriver Pathways was the realization that I'm not alone in this journey. I felt truly seen, and it gave me real hope that I can find a career even with my lived experience and everything going on in the world. Having people who have actually been through it give me real tips on how to navigate the career and employment system made all the difference. This program gave me hope again. Someone told me today the difference between hope and optimism is that hope has a plan. And that's exactly how I feel about the Thriver's Pathways Program.*
>
> **SARA ELLIS**

PROGRAM PARTNERS

Str8Up Employment Services

Doing Good Works

Thriver Pathways was made possible through the collaboration of **Doing Good Works** and **Str8Up Employment Services** — partners who believe that workforce development and community belonging are not separate goals.

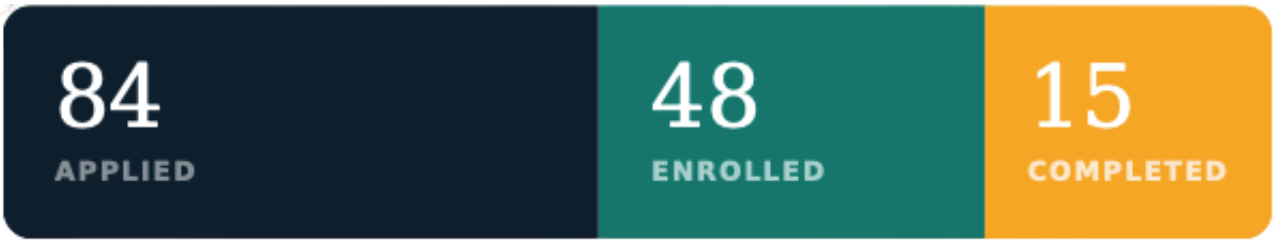
PROGRAM AT A GLANCE

The Numbers behind the journey

From application through completion, Thriver Pathways produced measurable outcomes across confidence, career readiness, and real-world job activity.

Program enrollment funnel

Demand for this program far exceeded capacity - 84 foster alumni applied for a cohort of 48 participants.



Completion data reflects participants who fulfilled all program requirements. Enrollment reflects all accepted participants. The gap between applications and available spots speaks to the unmet need this program addresses.

100%
FELT BETTER EQUIPPED AFTER THE PROGRAM

4.85/5
FACILITATOR RATING

95%
WOULD RECOMMEND TO OTHERS

8
ACCEPTED EMPLOYMENT OR INTERNSHIPS

82%
ACTIVELY APPLIED TO JOBS DURING PROGRAM

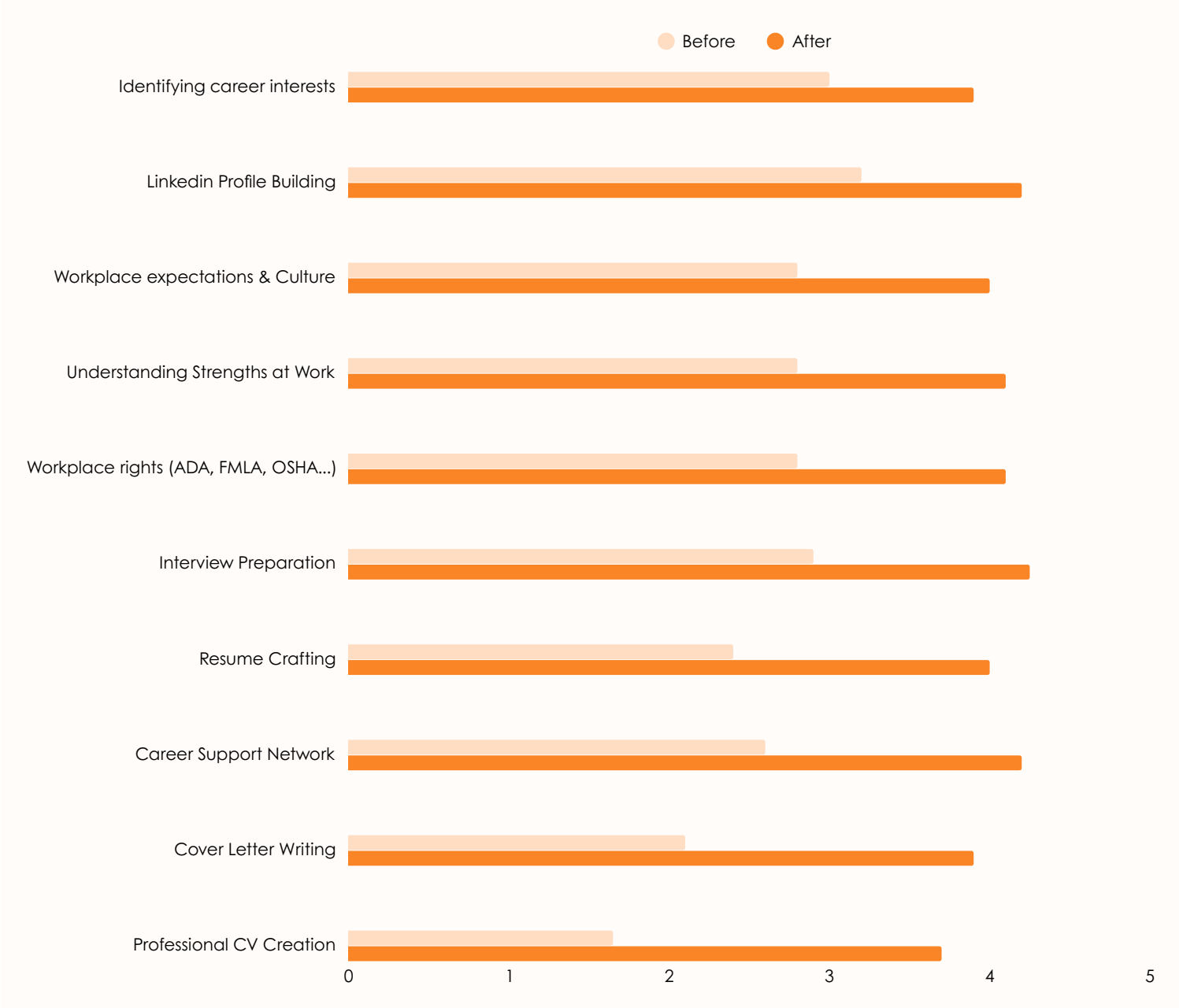
CONFIDENCE OUTCOMES

From uncertain to *equipped*

Post-program survey participants self-rated their confidence before and after the program across ten career-readiness areas. Every area showed meaningful growth.

Confidence Before & After Thriver Pathways

Self-rated on a 5-point scale (1 = not confident, 5 = extremely confident)



CAREER SKILLS

Post-program skill confidence

At program's end, participants rated how strongly they agreed with 11 career readiness statements — from values clarity to job-search readiness. Every measure landed above 4.3 out of 5.

> *You will be surprised about the new things you learn that you didn't know before. Every new information is a helpful tool to move forward towards your dream job, career, and future.*
> **ALEX MALDONADO**

Of participants who applied for jobs during the program, *10 received interviews* **- and 7 accepted new career opportunities.**

41%

ACCEPTED A CAREER OPPORTUNITY

SKILL BY SKILL

Growth in every area

Each skill measured before and after the program. The arc of growth tells the story.

> *You will be surprised about the new things you learn that you didn't know before. Every new information is a helpful tool to move forward towards your dream job, career, and future.*
>
> **ALEX MALDONADO**

Understanding workplace rights

Crafting a resume & cover letter

Interview Preparation

Values, mindsets, & Strengths

Building a professional network

Resume & Cover letter Components

Job search Readiness

Finding Career Resources

EMPLOYMENT ACTIVITY

Moving from readiness to opportunity

82% of post-survey respondents ***actively applied*** for jobs, internships, or career opportunities during the program. Here's what that activity led to.

14

Participants actively applied for jobs, internships, or professional development during the program.

11

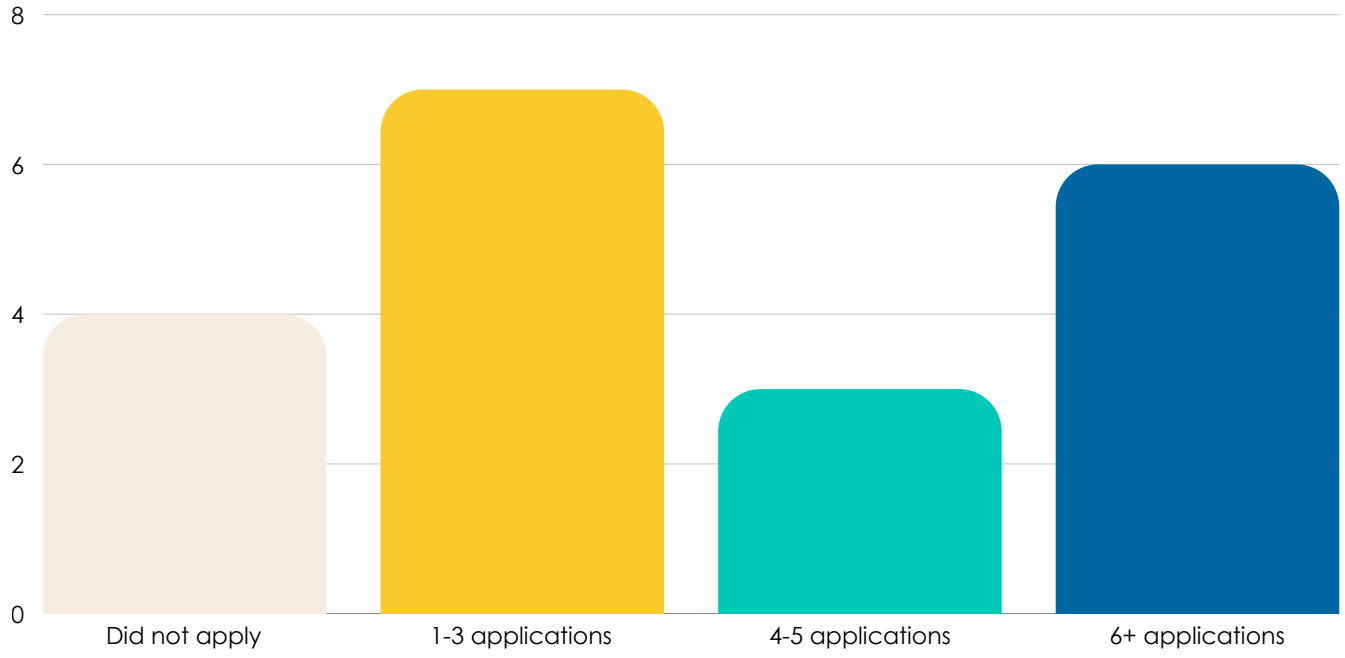
Participants received interviews — 4 received 3 or more interviews each.

8

Participants accepted a job offer, internship, or part-time role — all in fields related to their career exploration.

How many opportunities did participants apply for?

During the program period



Thriver Pathways Program, Foster Greatness March 2026

SESSIONS

What participants valued most

Thriver Pathways comprised four core sessions plus a capstone Resume & Cover Letter Lab. Participants rated each session's helpfulness for their career development.

1	Values, Mindsets, & Strengths	3.8/5
2	Workplace Myths v. Realities & Your Rights	3.8/5
3	Discovering Career Interests & Opportunities	4.1/5
4	Purpose to Profile: Resumes & More	4.4/5
5	Resume & Cover Letter Lab Session	4.4/5

> *I learned my experiences are not only just valuable on paper, but can change the world! Join to learn more about yourself, find community, and to be connected to opportunities!*
>
> **KEONA ROSE**

> *It's an engaging and supportive community that takes the complexity and anxiety out of job hunting!*
>
> **LEIGH-ANNA FAITH**

SESSIONS

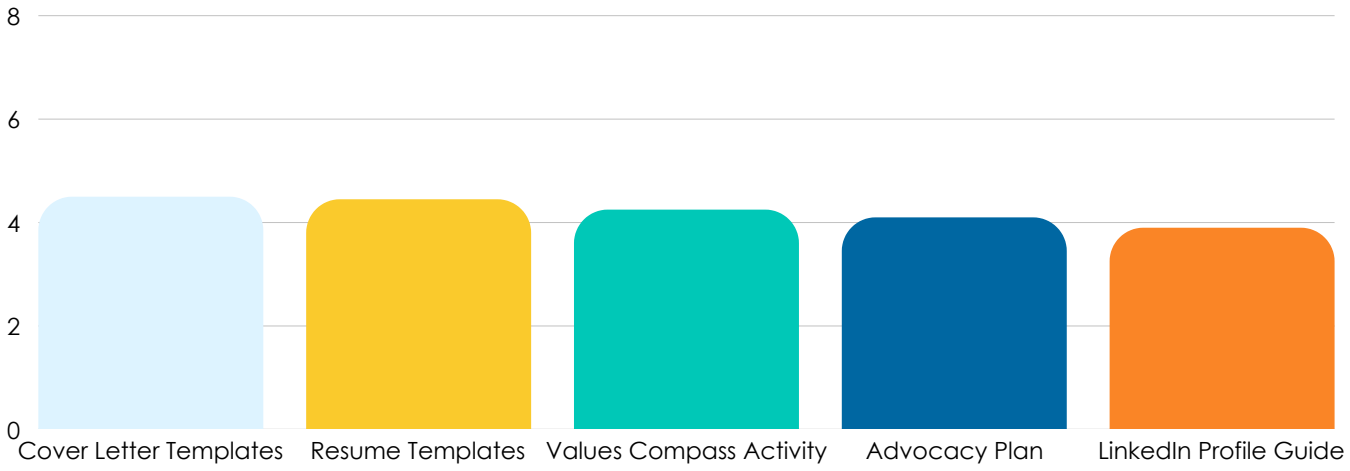
What participants valued most

Thriver Pathways comprised four core sessions plus a capstone Resume & Cover Letter Lab. Participants rated each session's helpfulness for their career development.

> *It gives you a good foundation to take with you as you begin your career journey.*
>
> **MONICA CONTRERAS**

Resource & Tools Helpfulness Ratings

Average helpfulness score out of 5.0



Thriver Pathways Program, Foster Greatness March 2026

Content Clarity

Materials were easy to understand and follow

Virtual Format

Zoom sessions worked well for learning styles

Facilitation Quality

Facilitators were knowledgeable, supportive, & engaging

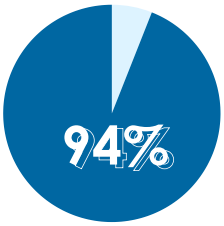
"It's not like every other one size fits all program. It felt like those teaching the course were invested in our success."

— Faith Sharp, Thriver Pathways participant

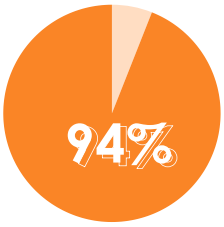
ESSENTIAL DOCUMENTS

Addressing barriers beyond the resume

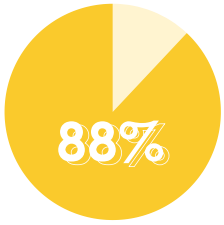
Thriver Pathways checked in on essential document access — a critical barrier for many foster alumni. The data shows strong access across most documents, with gaps that the program and partners actively worked to address.



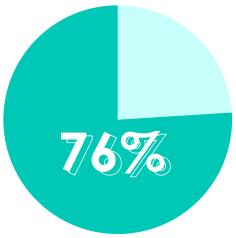
SOCIAL SECURITY CARD



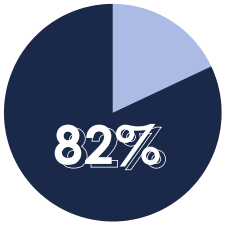
STATE ID / DRIVER'S LICENSE



BIRTH CERTIFICATE



HIGH SCHOOL DISPLOMA / GED



ANY COLLEGE TRANSCRIPTS

Document access support made the difference.

One participants confirmed the program helped them access or obtain an essential document during enrollment. For foster alumni - many of whom have navigated placement transitions without consistent record-keeping - this kind o barrier removal is not a side note. It is the work.

WHAT PARTICIPANTS ASKED FOR MORE

Listening to build what's next

Participant feedback directly shapes how this program grows. The themes below reflect the clearest asks from our community — each one a roadmap for the next cohort.

> *I walked away with actual knowledge and feeling like I learned things I did not know going into the program. I actually feel like my time was worth it being in this program.*
>
> **JOANNA MANDUJANO**

Interviewing skills & practice — 12

The most requested topic: participants want dedicated time for interview techniques, mock rounds, and storytelling practice.

Job placement assistance & employer connections — 12

Top program improvement request — direct pathways to employers alongside the curriculum. Our Staffmark partnership directly answers this ask.

One-on-one coaching sessions — 11

Participants want more individualized time — live resume reviews, personalized feedback, and one-on-one guidance from coaches.

Networking & peer-mentorship — 9

Participants want structured peer connections and informational interviews — the relational infrastructure of long-term career growth.

More hands-on activities — 9

Participants responded well to active learning formats — they want more applied, practice-based work built into future sessions.

PARTNER SPOTLIGHT

What comes after the program?

Extended career support through Staffmark.

The journey doesn't end when the cohort does. Foster Greatness has partnered with Staffmark — one of the nation's leading workforce solutions companies — to ensure Thriver Pathways alumni have continued access to career support, job placement resources, and employment opportunities long after graduation.

THE STAFFMARK PARTNERSHIP

Staffmark's partnership with Foster Greatness extends the reach of Thriver Pathways beyond the program itself — giving members ongoing access to job boards, skills development, and employer connections.

This is what the community asked for most: a pathway that doesn't stop at readiness. Through Staffmark, our alumni move from career-ready to career-achieved — with a partner invested in their long-term success.

WHAT MEMBERS GAIN

Job placement support, employer connections, and access to Staffmark's national hiring network — continuing the career momentum built during Thriver Pathways.

WHY IT MATTERS

12 of 17 participants said job placement assistance was the program improvement they wanted most. This partnership is a direct response — from data to action.

Interested in partnering with Foster Greatness?

Thriver Pathways is built for expansion — and we're actively seeking corporate partners who want to invest in a community that is changing how foster alumni access careers. From curriculum sponsorship to direct hiring pathways, there are meaningful ways to grow this work together. Visit fostergreatness.co or reach out directly to explore what partnership looks like for your organization.